



Inspection Report

Boston University
85 East Newton St., Room 426
Boston, MA 02118

Customer ID: **112**

Certificate: **14-R-0017**

Site: 003

BOSTON UNIVERSITY MEDICAL
SCHOOL

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 29-APR-2026

2.31(c)(7) Critical Repeat

Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC).

An approximately 2-week-old male piglet covered under a research protocol was transported to the facility on January 20, 2026, and examined by a veterinarian on this date with no abnormalities noted in the medical record. This animal was used in a study-approved behavioral experiment on January 21, 2026. The institution specifies in its "Acclimation of Large Animals Policy" that a 7-day acclimation period is required before animals are used for any survival experiments.

The animal was provided with food on January 20, 2026, but laboratory personnel requested that the facility delay morning feeding on January 21, 2026, until after the behavioral experiment was completed. However, fasting prior to experiments was not an approved activity under the research protocol. The piglet was found by veterinary staff later in the day shivering and in lateral recumbency, with mild hindlimb ataxia observed after the animal began walking. The animal was provided with supportive care, including 5% dextrose solution, and monitored closely until it was fully recovered from this incident.

Additionally, on November 10, 2025, a piglet used in a study-approved MRI on the above-mentioned research protocol was anesthetized but not intubated as required under the protocol. No adverse effects were noted other than a drop in oxygen saturation below 94%.

Fasting without prior protocol approval and altering anesthetic procedures constitute significant deviations from the approved activities in this research protocol, while experimental use of the animals within the acclimation period constitutes a significant deviation from an institutional policy. Failure to adhere to activities covered under the research protocols and institutional policies prevents full IACUC oversight of research activities involving animals and has resulted in severe animal welfare impacts. Principal investigators must follow the IACUC-approved proposals and institutional policies, and any proposed changes shall be reviewed and approved by the IACUC prior to implementation.

This incident was reported in the IACUC meeting minutes and corrective measures, including increased feeding frequencies, the use of detailed feed logs, and a full review of the "Acclimation of Large Animals Policy", had been implemented prior to the inspection.

Prepared By: MICHAEL BROOKS

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date:

04-MAY-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:

04-MAY-2026



Inspection Report

2.33(b)(2)

Repeat

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care.

On December 15, 2025, a male rhesus macaque covered under a research protocol was administered Simbadol (buprenorphine) that was 10 days past the manufacturer's suggested use of 56 days after the first puncture of the vial, but still within the manufacturer's expiration date for an unpunctured vial. There were no adverse effects noted from the administration of this expired medication.

An expired medication may not be safe or effective and is not an appropriate method for the treatment or prevention of animal health issues. The facility must ensure that methods of treatment, including the medications maintained for use in animals, are appropriate.

This incident was reported in the IACUC meeting minutes and corrective measures, including ensuring that vials are appropriately labeled with expiration dates, had been implemented prior to the inspection.

3.80(a)(2)(iii)

Primary enclosures.

On January 8, 2026, a male cynomolgus macaque was found to have escaped from its primary enclosure. This animal sustained a minor hand injury and other minor wounds that were evaluated and treated by a veterinarian, which included suturing the hand wound as well as administering antibiotics and analgesics. Upon further investigation, the animal was discovered to have escaped by pushing a pan through a latch and exploiting the resulting gap that would contain a larger animal.

Failure to house nonhuman primates in secure primary enclosures may allow them to escape and sustain injuries. The facility must ensure that primary enclosures are constructed and maintained to contain nonhuman primates securely and prevent accidental opening of the enclosure, including opening by the animal.

This incident was reported in the IACUC meeting minutes and corrective measures, including locking the latch that the animal exploited, had been implemented prior to the inspection. To remain corrected from April 30, 2026, forward.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with facility representatives.

Prepared By: MICHAEL BROOKS

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date:

04-MAY-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
112	14-R-0017	003	BOSTON UNIVERSITY MEDICAL SCHOOL	29-APR-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000036	<i>Macaca mulatta</i>	RHESUS MACAQUE
000059	<i>Chlorocebus aethiops</i>	AFRICAN GREEN MONKEY / GRIVET
000270	<i>Heterocephalus glaber</i>	NAKED MOLE-RAT
000010	<i>Macaca fascicularis</i>	CRAB-EATING MACAQUE / CYNOMOLGUS MONKEY
000021	<i>Mesocricetus auratus</i>	SYRIAN / GOLDEN HAMSTER
000002	<i>Sus scrofa domestica</i>	DOMESTIC PIG / POTBELLY PIG / MICRO PIG
000398	Total	